

7.4 Search Tools



Google has now entered the arena of desktop search

The Internet, as we've already stressed, is a vast repository of information. Now, to scour through this huge collection of data, we need effective search tools. Today, search is almost synonymous with Google, so much so that 'to google up something' is fast replacing the phrase 'to look up something'. Google has also launched a desktop search tool that indexes all the files on your computer while your PC is idle. This ensures that you get results quick whenever you type in a query. This is a major development from the earlier approach, where the search tool started searching only after the query was posted.

On the Internet, too, there are a number of search engines employing a number of different techniques. The first Web search engine was Wandex, a now-defunct index collected by the World Wide Web Wanderer, a Web crawler developed by Matthew Gray at MIT in 1993. The earliest search engine project